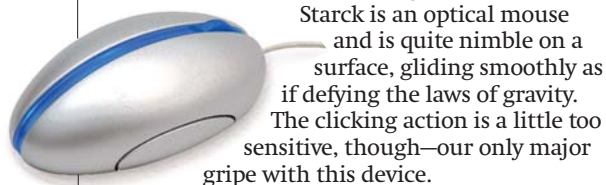


Designer Pointer

This underwhelming mouse from Microsoft was designed by Frenchman Philippe Starck. Thankfully, it is not underwhelming to the point of being boring or unappealing. A strait divides the top of the mouse into two halves, which act as either buttons. The strait, in turn, is illuminated with a blue light that contrasts well with the silver body of the mouse.



Starck is an optical mouse and is quite nimble on a surface, gliding smoothly as if defying the laws of gravity. The clicking action is a little too sensitive, though—our only major gripe with this device.

At Rs 1,876 this designer mouse should go down well with executives but gamers may give it a no-go.

Company **Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 1,876**
Phone **011-26294600**
E-mail **connect@microsoft.com**
Web site **www.microsoft.com**

Rating

PowerDisk MP3 Watch

Watch This

And now, a regular-looking wristwatch that can play MP3s. Seriously! The PowerDisk MP3 wristwatch looks like a chunky piece of time wear complete with big buttons and all. What this really has is the ability to play MP3s. With a capacity of 128 MB, you can store about 20 to 25 of your favourite tracks using the supplied retractable USB cable. The device is recognised as plug-and-play by Windows XP and can also be used for data storage. Obviously, the feature set and playback options are limited as compared to a full-fledged MP3 player. We got about 9.5 hours of continuous playtime on a fully charged battery. Audio quality, though not the best, is surprisingly decent.



Company **Max Infosolutions**
Price **Rs 7500 for MP-1686-08066-2B (128MB), Rs 5600 for MB-1386B (128MB), Rs 9000 for MP-1686-07220-A (256MB)**
Phone **022-55974224**
E-mail **info@maxinfosolutions.com**

Rating

New & Notable

Motorola MPx200

Unlike other PDA phones from Sony Ericsson or Palm, the MPx200 from Motorola is rather slim and does not employ touch-screen for data input. This smart cell phone, when combined with Microsoft's Windows Mobile 2002 OS, offers easy one-handed operation. The sturdy build and lustrous satin black body are attractive, but fingerprint imprints are unavoidable. The 65K colour LCD is amongst the best we have seen. A monochrome sub-LCD up front displays basic information like time, date and caller ID. Features, though, is where this phone may fall short of enticing consumers. With no camera, Bluetooth or even FM radio, the Rs 16,500 price tag seems steep. You do get a SD/MMC slot, IR and a USB cable as the syncing apparatus. Performance is normally peppy, although short bursts of sluggishness do creep in ever so often.



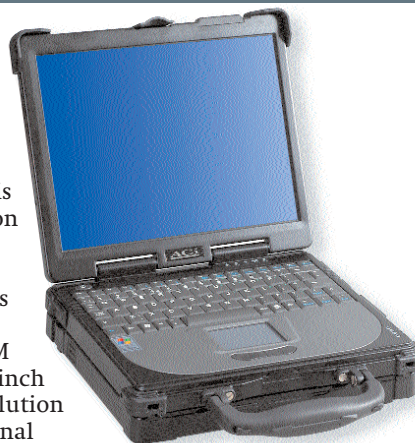
Company **Esource Global**
Price **Rs 16,500**
Phone **022-55021620**
E-mail **sales@esourceglobal.com**
Web site **www.motorola.com**

Rating

ACi Commando

Tough Nut

The Commando from ACi is a rugged notebook made of die-cast magnesium alloy. However, the tough construction does add extra weight to the notebook, which is further increased by the addition of a docking station offering extra I/O ports, a floppy and a combo drive. The hardware runs on an Intel Pentium M 1.1 GHz processor with 256MB DDR RAM and a 40 GB hard drive. Its 12.1-inch TFT screen runs at a native resolution of 1024x768. It also has an internal 802.11b Wi-Fi card for wireless access.



Under our multimedia-rich battery test, the laptop ran for 3 hours and 55 minutes, it will last longer under normal usage. A long battery life is always desirable in a mobile device.

The Commando is certainly a good buy for those looking for a laptop to be used under harsh conditions where it might be prone to mechanical shocks.

Company **Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt Ltd**
Price **Rs 1,50,000**
Phone **022-56407000**
E-mail **support@aci-asia.com**
Web site **www.aci-asia.com**

Rating